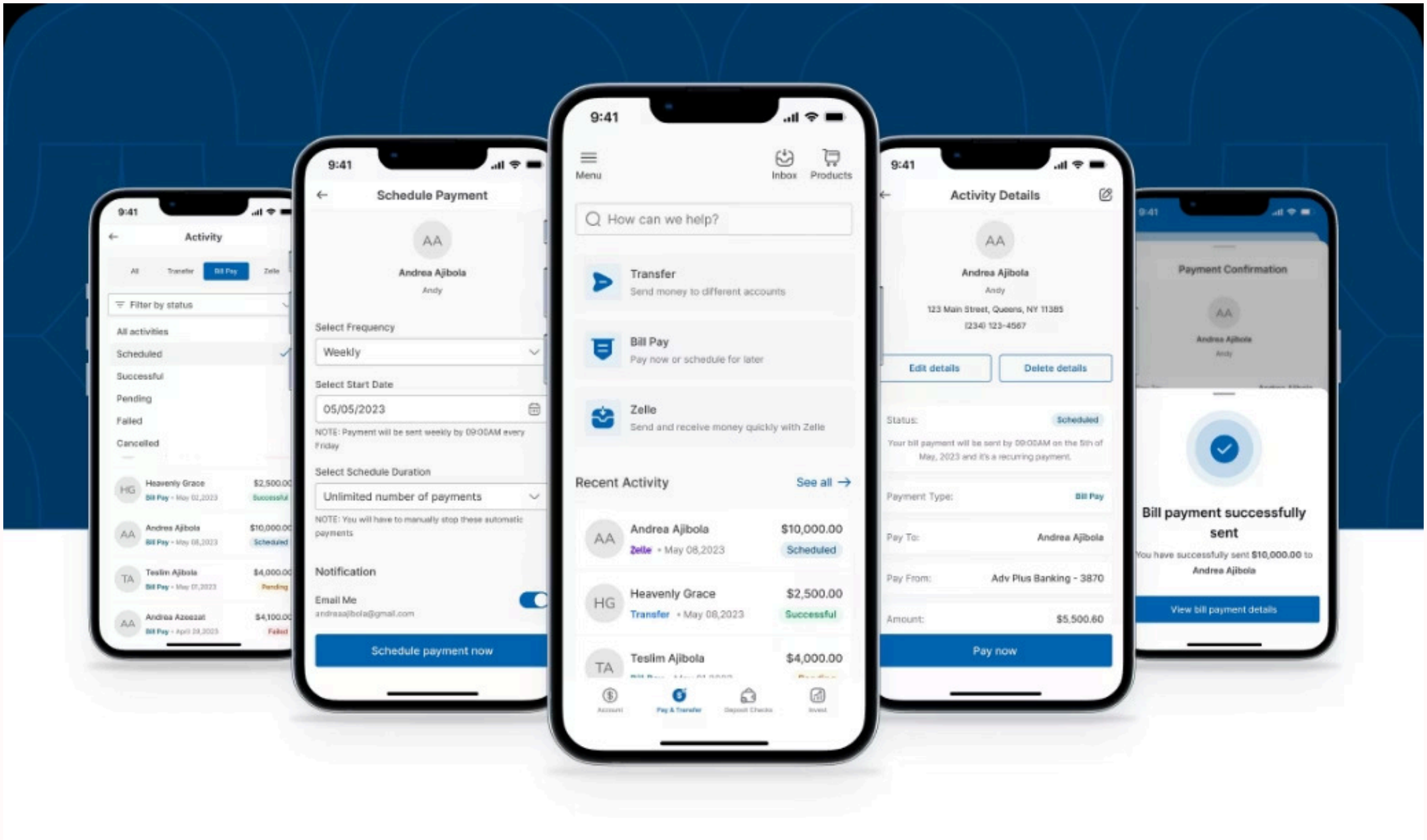
Bank of America
Bill Payment Case Study



Enhancing digital banking experience for over 68 million customers through an intuitive and user-friendly Bill Pay feature redesign.

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Project Overview

Bank of America, serving over 68 million customers, introduced a new Bill Pay feature in 2022. This feature allows users to handle payments for utilities, cable, phone services, and more through electronic transactions, available as early as the next working day.

The project focused on improving the user experience of the Bill Pay feature on the Bank of America mobile app. By addressing real customer needs and pain points, the team aimed to make the process more intuitive and user-friendly.

1. **Introduction**
   New Bill Pay feature launched in 2022
2. **Identification**
   Customer needs and pain points addressed
3. **Improvement**
   User experience enhanced for intuitive bill payments

68m+
Total customers and small business clients.

57m+
Total verified digital users & customers

66%
Users who utilize Bill Pay to make online bill payments

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Project Team

The project was led by a collaborative team working remotely to enhance the Bill Pay feature. As the product designer and researcher, I worked alongside the lead product designer, and a dedicated team of four UX designers and researchers.

Our collective goal was to simplify and improve the bill payment scheduling process, enhance payment history visibility, and create a seamless user experience for Bank of America customers.

Product Designer

Led research and design efforts

Lead Designer

Guiding the project

UX Team

Four designers and researchers

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Identifying Challenges

Despite Bank of America's app aiming to simplify financial management, many users expressed dissatisfaction with the Bill Pay feature. Key issues identified included complexity in managing and scheduling bill payments, limited flexibility in modifying options and delivery dates, confusion around payment formats and schedules, and challenges in tracking and viewing payment history.

Our research question became: "How can we help users manage bill payments, schedule future payments, and track payment histories more effectively within the Bank of America app?"

1 Payment Scheduling

Users struggled with complex bill payment management and scheduling.

2 Limited Flexibility

Modifying options and delivery dates proved challenging for many users.

3 Confusing Formats

Payment formats and schedules were not clear to users.

4 History Tracking

Users faced difficulties in tracking and viewing their payment history.

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Project Goals

The project aimed to refine and enhance the Bill Pay feature in the Bank of America mobile app. Our primary objectives were to simplify scheduling and management of bill payments, improve visibility and usability of the payment history, and empower users with a smoother and more efficient banking experience.

These goals were set to address the key pain points identified during our initial research and to create a more user-friendly Bill Pay feature that would meet the needs of Bank of America's diverse customer base.

1

Simplify Payments

Make bill scheduling and management easier

2

Improve History

Enhance visibility of payment history

3

Empower Users

Create a smoother banking experience

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User Research

To understand users' pain points, we conducted comprehensive research involving user feedback analysis from app stores, surveys to capture a wide range of user preferences and experiences, and in-depth user interviews to delve into user frustrations and uncover areas for improvement.

Key insights revealed that users desire a simpler and more flexible bill payment system, and that clearer payment tracking and real-time notifications are essential for a better experience.

User Feedback Analysis

Gathered insights from app store reviews, highlighting common issues with payment scheduling and history tracking.

Surveys

Conducted to capture a wide range of user preferences and experiences with the Bill Pay feature.

User Interviews

In-depth sessions allowed us to delve into user frustrations, uncovering specific areas for improvement in the Bill Pay feature.

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Target User Persona

Our research identified two main user groups for the Bill Pay feature. The first group consists of individual users who rely on the app for personal bill payments and often need to schedule payments and track transactions. These users value simplicity and convenience in managing their personal finances.

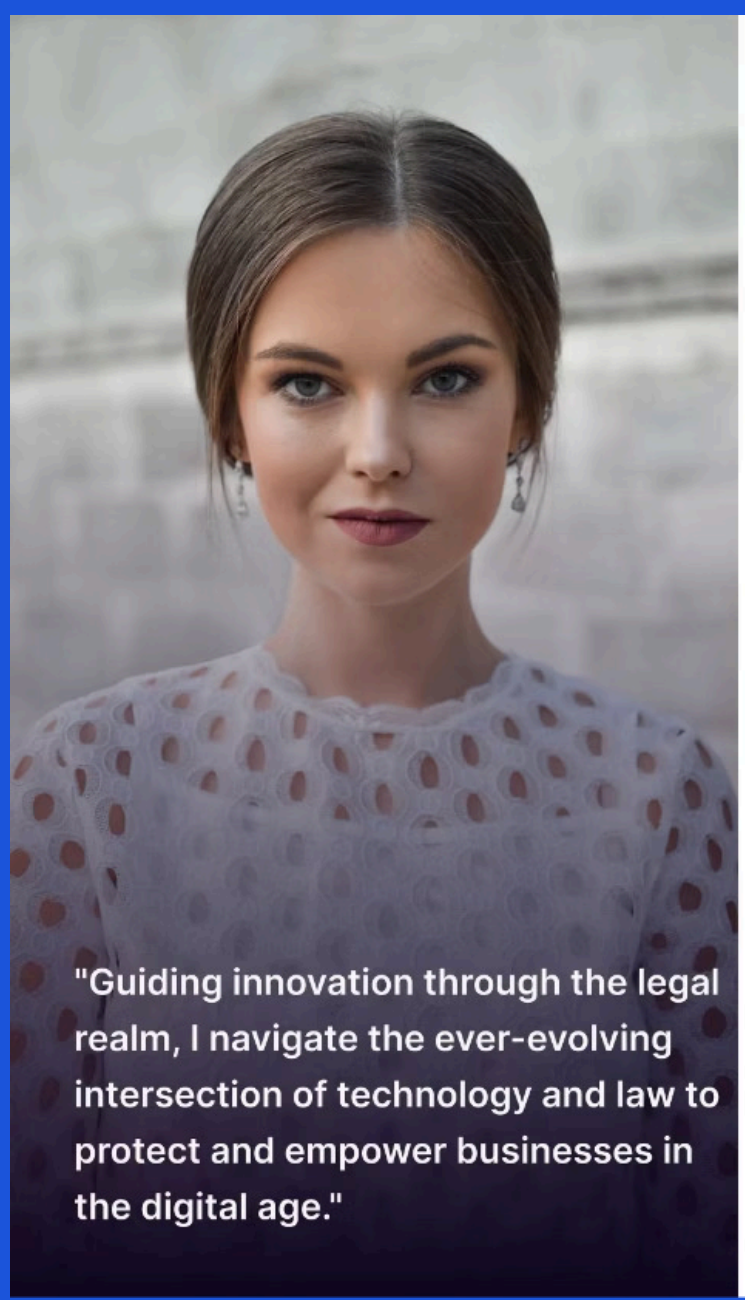
The second group comprises business owners who handle multiple transactions and depend on the app's convenience for managing various financial tasks. These users require more robust features for managing complex payment schedules and tracking multiple transactions efficiently.

Individual Users

Rely on the app for personal bill payments, need to schedule payments and track transactions easily.

Business Owners

Handle multiple transactions, require robust features for managing complex payment schedules and tracking.



Daniella Jacobs

Tech Lawyer

Individual

Profile

Age: 28 Years Old

Status: Single

Income Level: Middle Class

Location: Florida, United States

Personality Traits

Introvert — Extrovert

Time Poor — Time Rich

Independent — Team Player

Bio

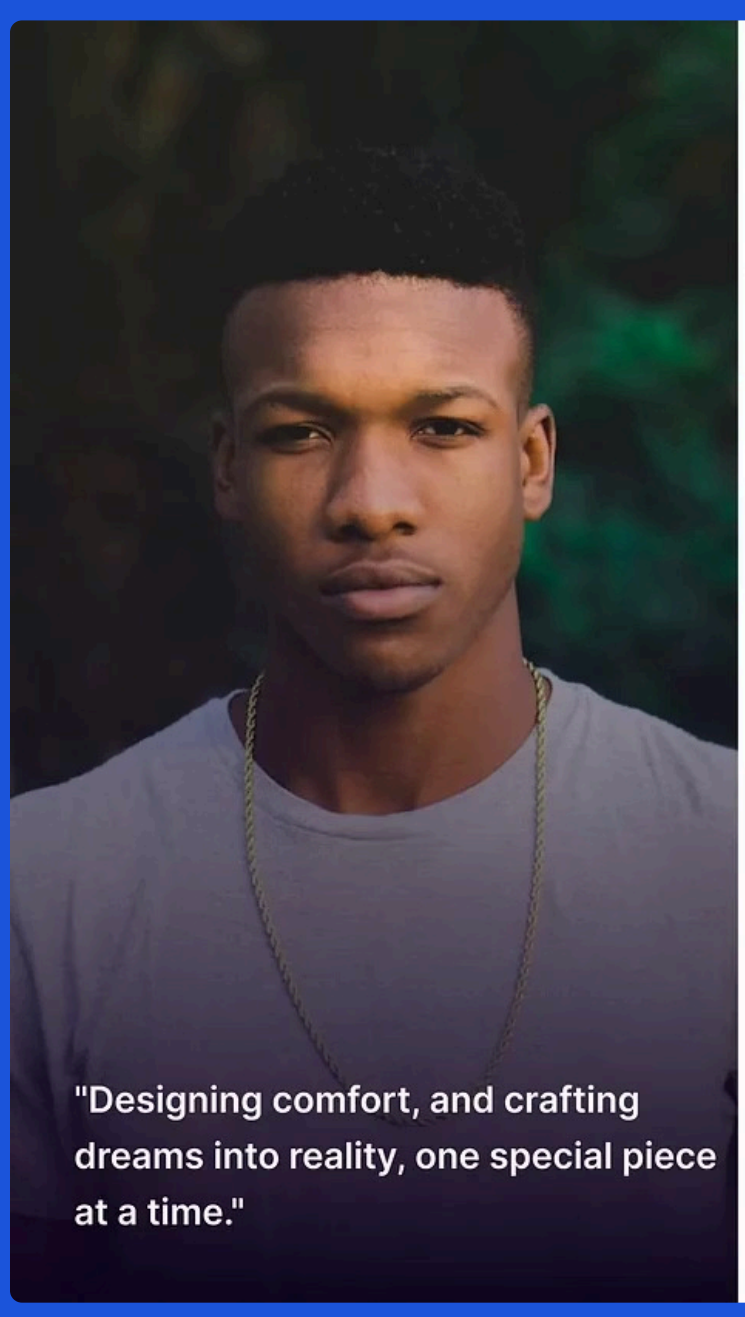
Daniella is a diligent tech lawyer based in Florida, United States. She has a strong passion for both law and technology, enabling her to merge her legal expertise with her profound understanding of the constantly evolving tech industry. As a frequent user of the Bank of America, she relies on the mobile app to efficiently manage her finances, schedule payments to ensure timely bill payments, and conveniently track her transaction history, all within a single platform.

Frustrations

- Difficulties in scheduling payments.
- A time-consuming and frustrating manual payment scheduling process.
- Unclear payment history for tracking transactions.

Needs

- An efficient way for managing bill payments.
- Flexibility in modifying scheduled payments.
- Improved clarity in tracking payment history.



Jason Williams

Furniture-Making Business Owner

Business Owner

Profile

Age: 33 Years Old

Status: Married

Income Level: Upper-Middle Class

Location: Ohio, United States

Personality Traits

Introvert — Extrovert

Time Poor — Time Rich

Independent — Team Player

Bio

With a passion for creating unique and high-quality furniture pieces, Jason has built a successful furniture-making business that caters to discerning clients. He excels in managing his business finances and paying bills to sustain and grow his venture. With meticulous financial planning and timely bill payments, he ensures smooth operations and maintains strong supplier relationships, leading to the continued success of his furniture-making business.

Frustrations

- Difficulties in scheduling payments.
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Needs

- An efficient way for managing bill payments.
- Flexibility in modifying scheduled payments.
- Improved clarity in tracking payment history.

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Solutions

Our user-centered solutions addressed the identified pain points through three key improvements. First, we improved bill payment management with a streamlined UI design, making it easier for users to set up and manage payments. Second, we enhanced scheduling flexibility, allowing users to specify payment dates, amounts, and recipients, with options to modify or cancel scheduled payments. Real-time notifications and intuitive prompts were added to keep users informed and reduce errors.

Lastly, we upgraded the payment history feature to provide a searchable, detailed view of past transactions, enabling users to filter by date, recipient, and payment type for precise tracking.

1

Improved Management

Streamlined UI for easier bill payment setup and management

2

Enhanced Flexibility

Greater control over payment scheduling with real-time notifications

3

Better Tracking

Upgraded payment history with detailed, searchable transactions

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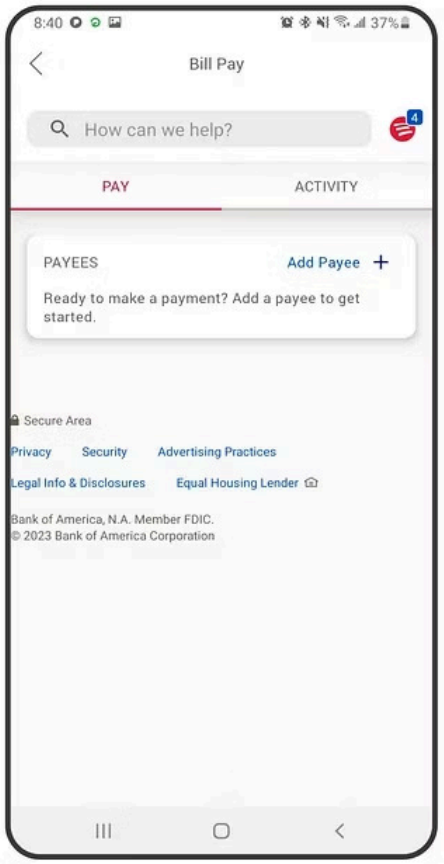

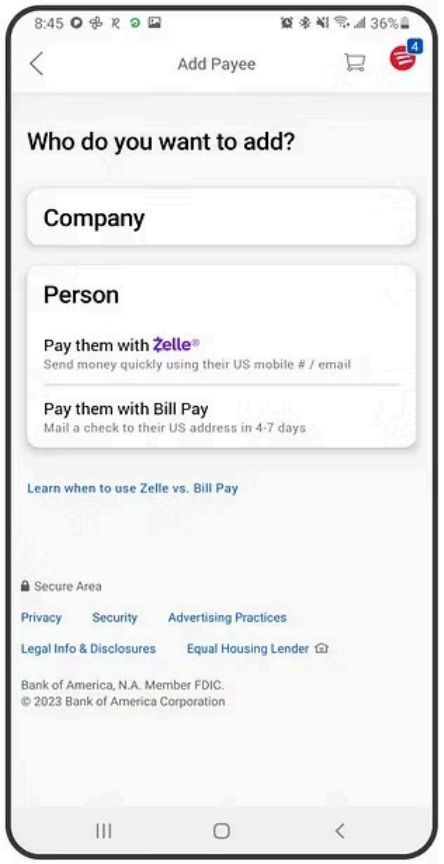

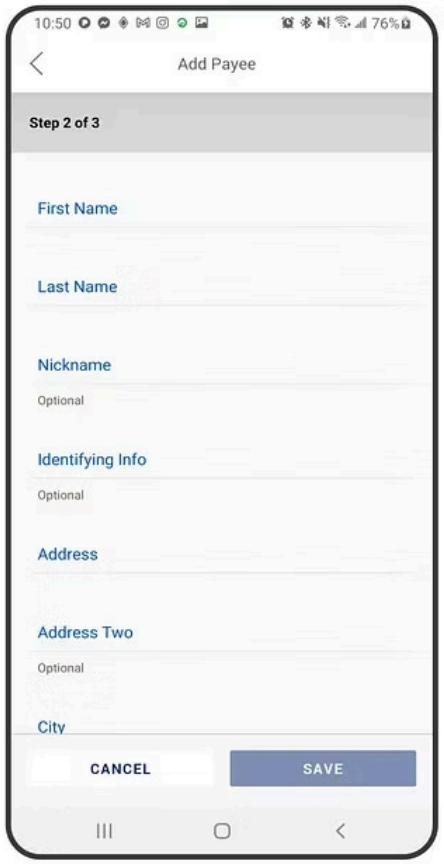

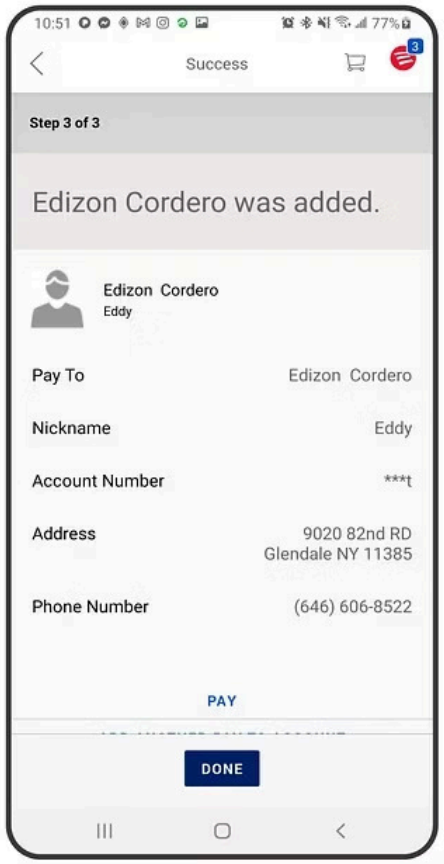

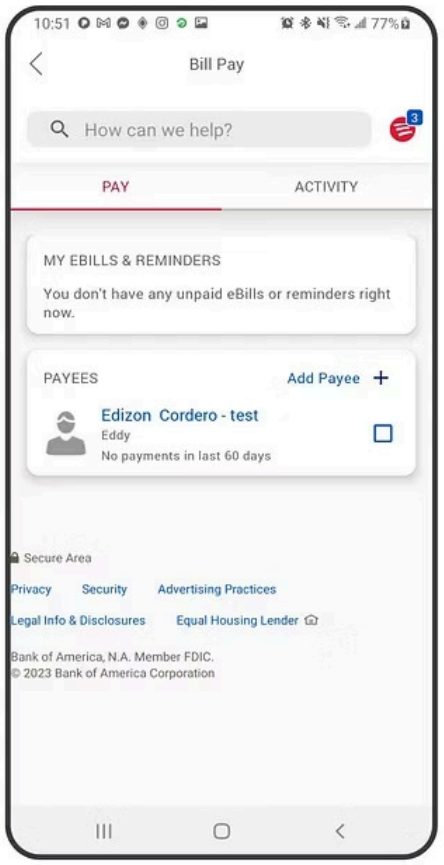

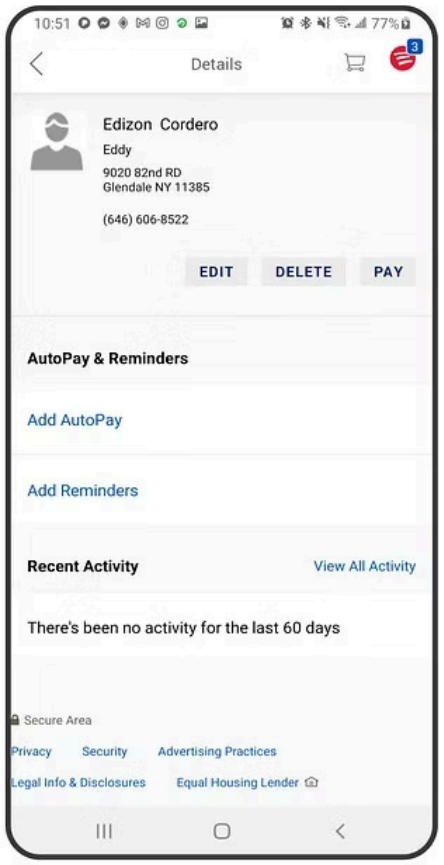

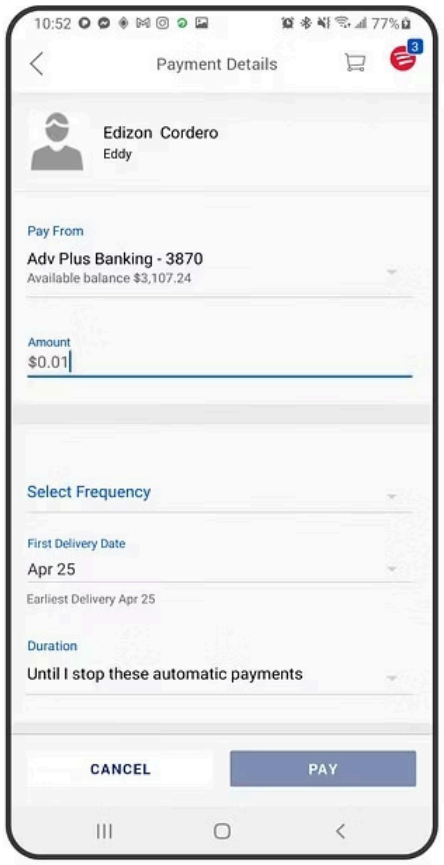

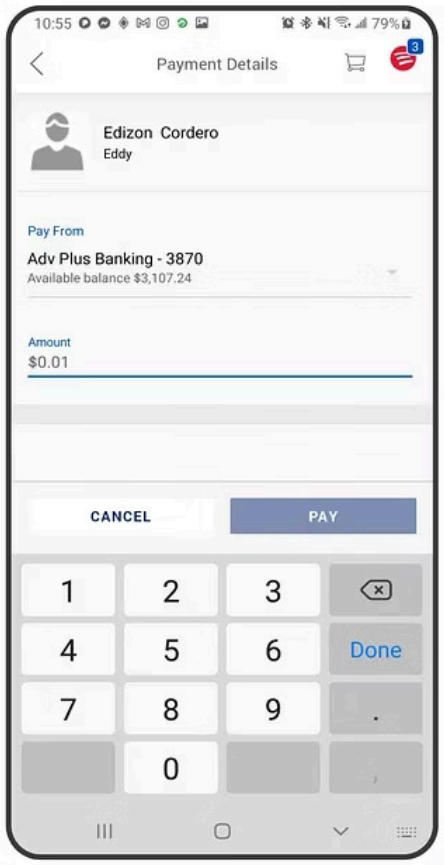

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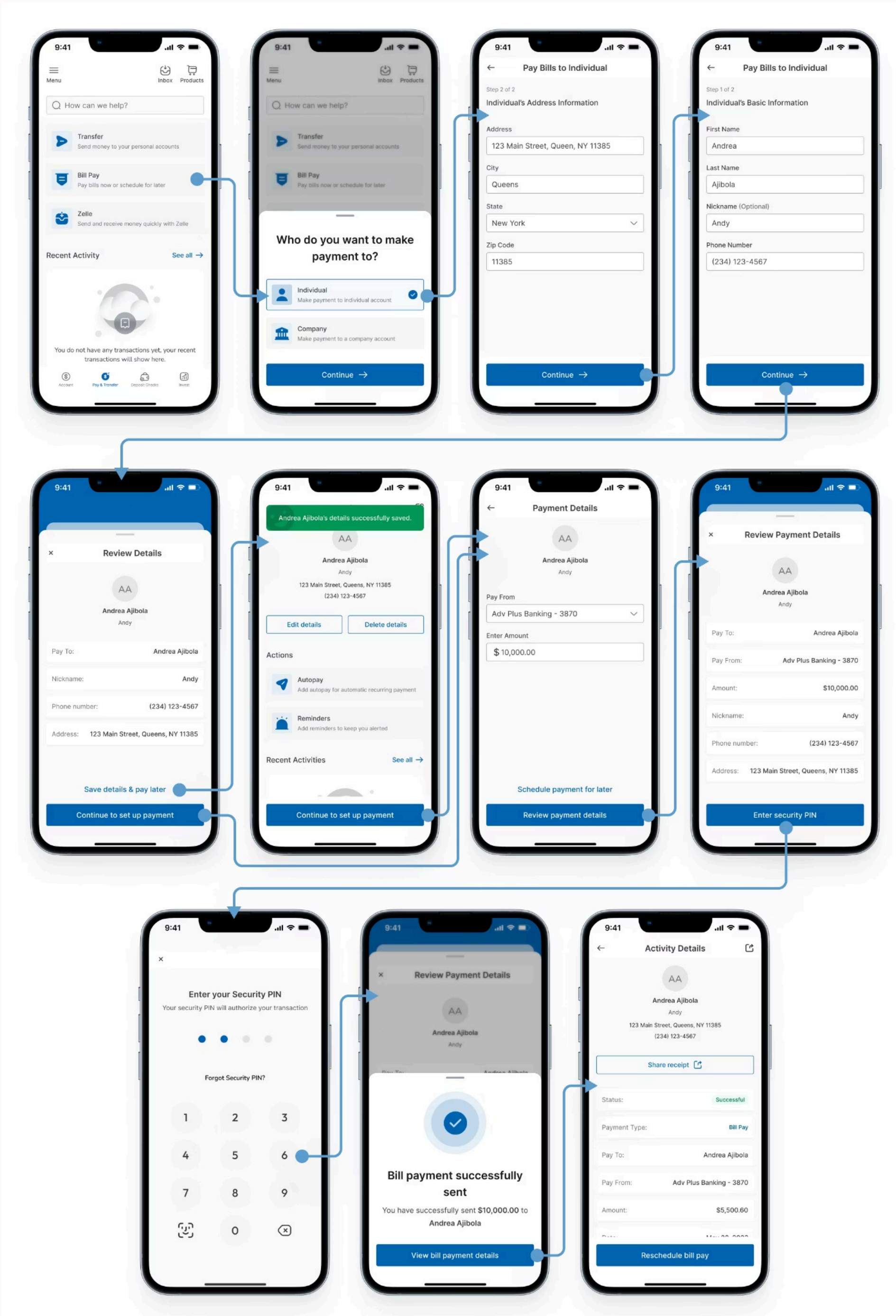
After



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Usability Testing

To validate the redesigned features and gauge user responses, we conducted thorough usability testing. We invited previous interview participants to test the new features, ensuring continuity in our research. The test execution involved realistic scenarios that allowed participants to simulate tasks like scheduling payments and reviewing payment history.

Comprehensive feedback was collected through video recordings, screen captures, and notes, providing deep insights into user interactions and areas for further refinement. This approach allowed us to identify any remaining pain points and validate the effectiveness of our solutions.

- Participant Selection

> Previous interview participants were invited to test the new features, ensuring familiarity with the project context.

- Test Execution

> Realistic scenarios were created to simulate tasks like scheduling payments and reviewing payment history, providing a comprehensive testing environment.

- Feedback Collection

> Comprehensive feedback was gathered through video recordings, screen captures, and detailed notes, offering deep insights into user interactions and areas for improvement.

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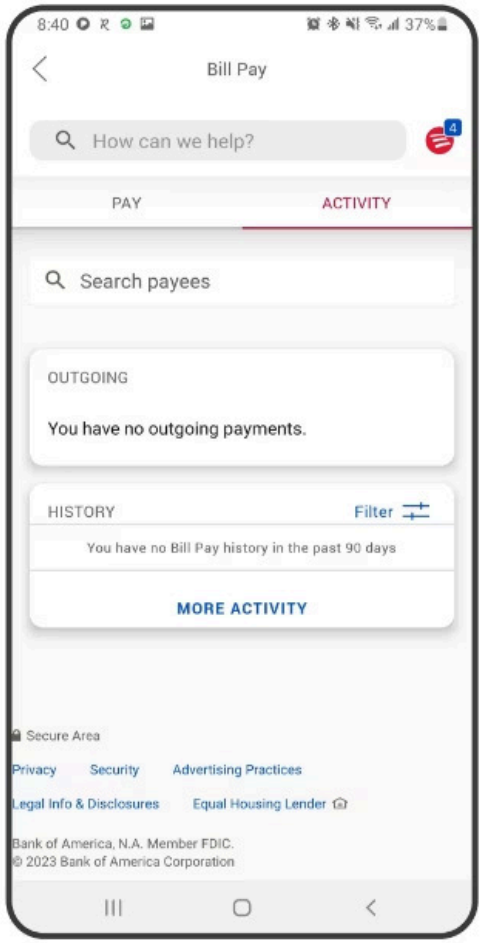
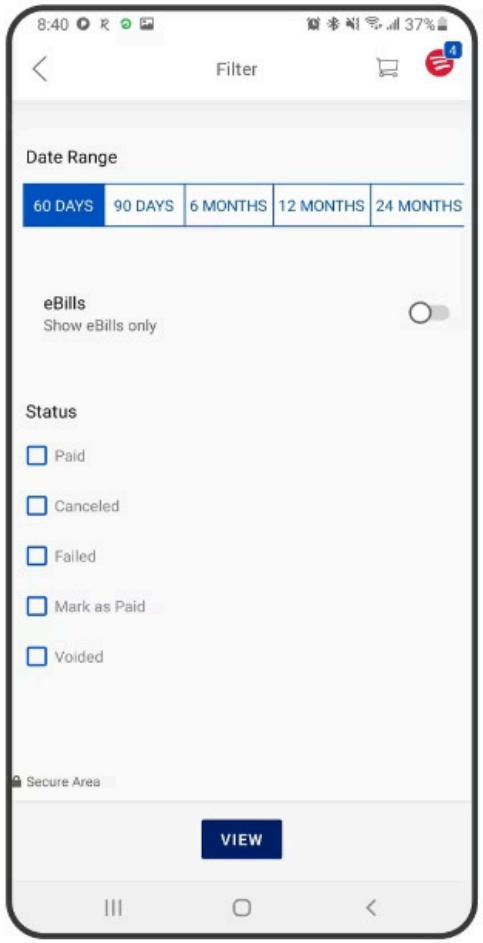
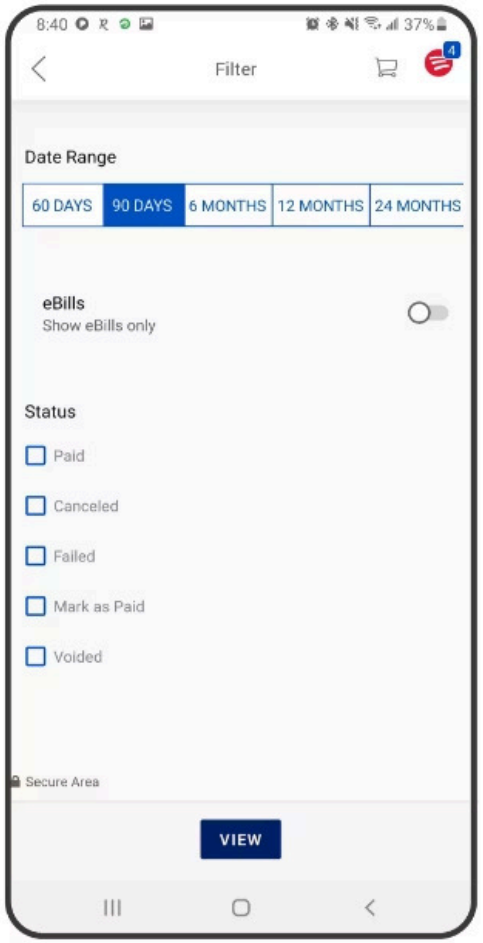
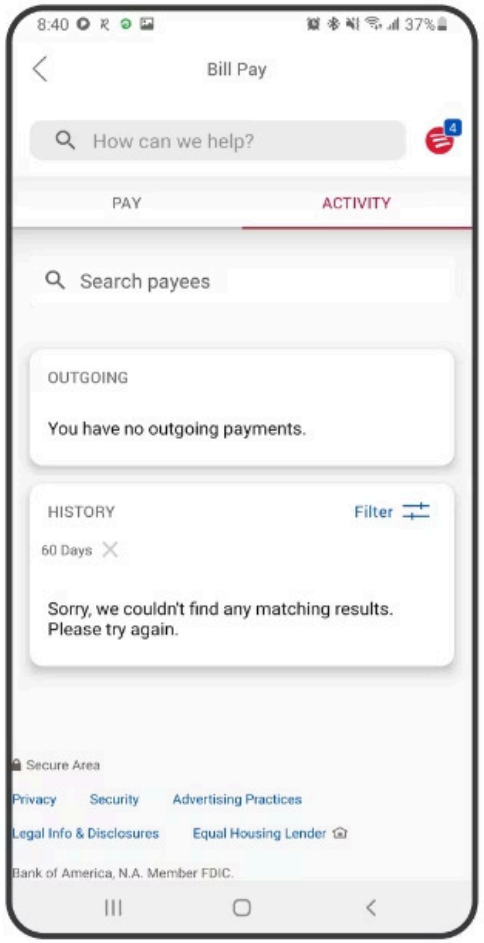
Before









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Iterative Design & Validation

Based on the valuable feedback received during usability testing, we made several iterations to further improve the Bill Pay feature. We added a delete button to allow for easier management of scheduled payments, addressing users' need for more control over their payment schedules.

Help text was included throughout the payment process to provide clear guidance and reduce user confusion. Additionally, we introduced a repeat bill payment button, enabling users to easily set up recurring payments and adding to the overall convenience of the feature. These iterations were crucial in refining the user experience and ensuring that the redesigned Bill Pay feature met user needs effectively.

Delete Button

Added for easier management of scheduled payments

Help Text

Included for clear guidance throughout the payment process

Repeat Payment

Button added to enable easy repetition of bill payments

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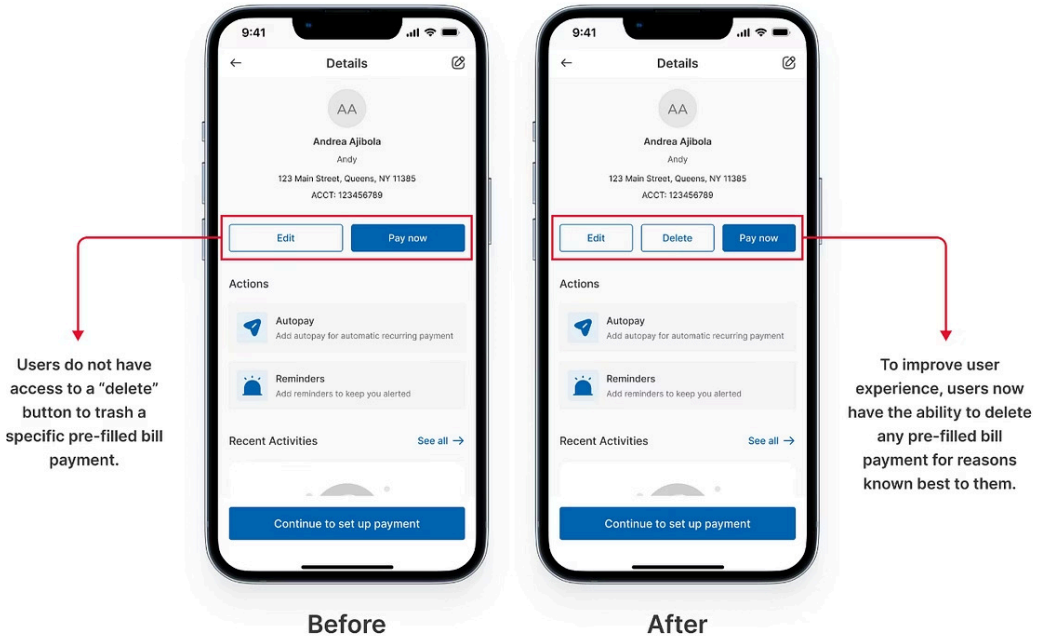
A Delete Button to improve user experience.



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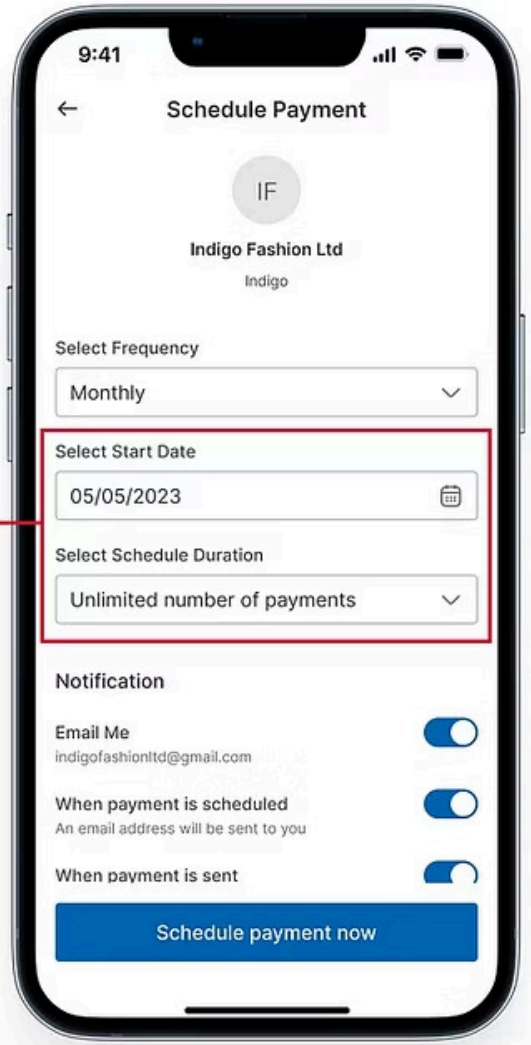
Help Text to facilitate clear and concise communication.



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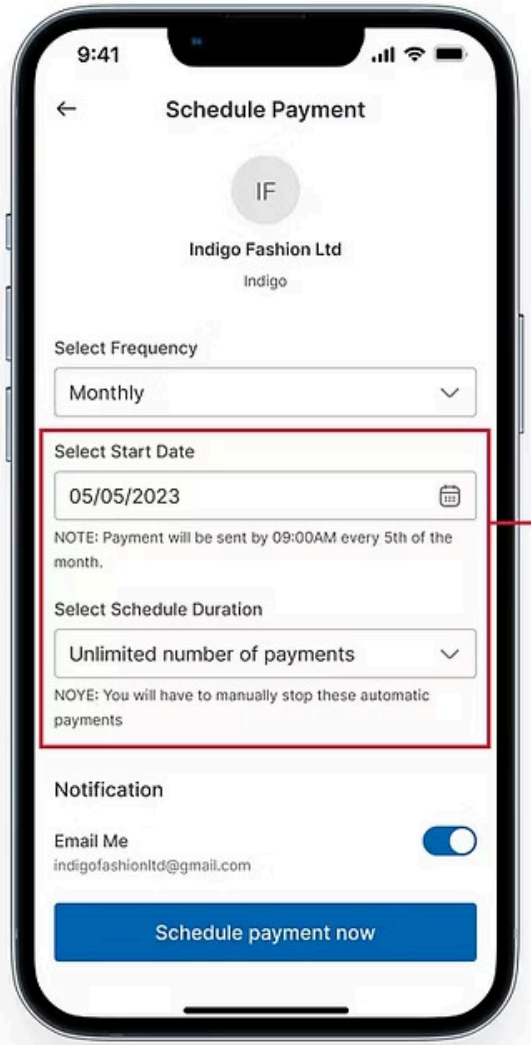

After

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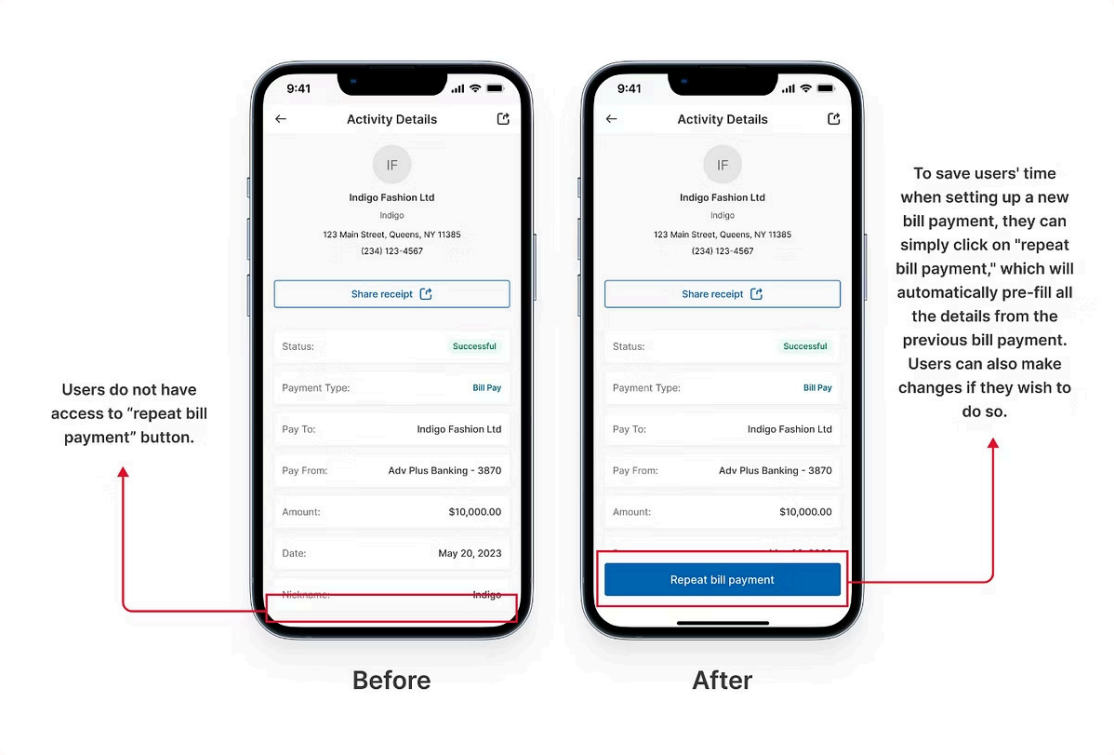
Repeat Bill Payment button to provide a more user-friendly and convenient experience.



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Validation Testing

Following design updates, a second round of usability testing was conducted to validate improvements and ensure alignment with user needs.

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Key Takeaways

- **User-Centric Design:** Actively incorporating user feedback significantly improved app usability and satisfaction.
- **Enhanced User Experience:** User-centered design principles contributed to positive feedback on payment scheduling and history tracking.
- **Collaborative Precision:** Successful app redesigns depend on teamwork and attention to detail.
- **Personal Development:** This project strengthened my design skills and highlighted the importance of focus and dedication in UX/UI projects.

The key takeaways from this project emphasize the power of user-centric design, the impact of enhanced user experiences, the value of collaborative precision, and the personal growth that can occur through dedicated UX/UI work. These insights will guide future design efforts and contribute to the ongoing success of the Bank of America Bill Pay feature.

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